Gate	Command or source	Expected result	Status
Workspace lock-step	npm run version 8.0.0-rc.1	All ten workspace packages and internal dependency pins report 8.0.0-rc.1.	Verified here: all ten confirmed.
Release metadata preflight	npm run release:preflight	Lock-step workspace metadata is valid.	Initially recorded as passing on exit 0, which was wrong — the command was a no-op (see below). Fixed on this branch; now prints the eleven-package lock-step summary and exits 1 on a mismatch.
Docs inventory	npm run docs:inventory	Documentation manifest remains valid after release docs are added.	Verified here: exit 0.
Runtime dependency audit	npm audit --omit=dev --audit-level=high	Zero high or critical runtime vulnerabilities.	Verified here: found 0 vulnerabilities.
Release gauntlet	npm run release:readiness	The fourteen-gate local gauntlet passes.	Verified here: release-readiness: ok.
Milestone-aware readiness	npm run release:readiness -- --milestone v8.0.0	Target milestone has zero open tracker items and no work-in-progress labels.	Verified here: all six report gates PASS. Required first: closing #518 and clearing stale work-in-progress labels from the already-closed #482 and #458.
Full test suite	npm test	Green.	Verified here on this release-prep branch via the gauntlet: 933 test files / 4,130 tests, summed across the twenty vitest chunks.
Lint	npm run lint	Clean across all workspace packages.	Verified here.